

ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4

PART A Group Interaction

This article appeared on a webpage:

Will everyone be eating insects by 2050?

By 2050 the population is expected to reach 9 billion. To feed all of those hungry mouths, we will need to produce almost twice as much food as we currently do. But that isn't going to be easy. One possible solution? Insects.

Eating insects is a common practice that's been taking place for thousands of years. Around 2 billion people regularly eat insects as part of their diet, and over 1,900 species are edible. The most commonly eaten bugs are beetles, caterpillars, bees, wasps and ants.

So what's so good about insects? Well, they're nutritious and healthy. Insects actually have a high fat, protein, vitamin, fibre and mineral content that is often comparable to fish or livestock. Beetles, for example, contain on average 205 g/kg protein; beef contains 256 g/kg.

Raising insects as a source of food as opposed to farmed animals is more environmentally friendly. Insects require significantly less land and water than traditionally-farmed animals and also reproduce much more quickly. Additionally, insects produce a fraction of the greenhouse gases when compared with other livestock, particularly cattle. Finally, insect farming can provide jobs and income to people living in poor areas. Insects are sustainable, green, nutritious and could help people out of poverty. Chocolate-covered caterpillars, anyone?

You are doing a project on the food we will eat in the future. Your group is meeting to discuss insects as food. You may want to talk about:

- how eating insects can benefit people and the environment
- why people may not want to eat insects
- how to promote insects as food
- anything else you think is important

PART B Individual Response

1. Would you like to try eating insects?
2. Is eating healthy food important to people in Hong Kong?
3. Should people change their diet to help the environment?
4. Do you think Hong Kong should promote eating insects?
5. Should restaurants have insects on their menu?
6. Do you think Hongkongers will eat more healthy foods in the future?
7. Should Hong Kong develop insect farms?
8. Can people impact the environment by changing their diet?